Name: Tommy Wang Period: 3

“Geese” by Mary Oliver

1. Oliver’s advice (lines 1–6)

Oliver tells the reader to stop trying to be perfect or punishing themselves for their mistakes. She says to accept what they naturally love and to talk honestly about their sadness. By offering to share her own sadness, she shows the reader that they don’t have to deal with it alone.

2. Sensory language and mood (lines 7–13)

Oliver mainly uses sight. The “clear pebbles of the rain” make the drops look like small, shiny stones, and the geese fly high in the “clean blue air.” These images create a calm, open mood because they shift our attention from our worries to the wide landscape and the steady movement of nature.

3. The purpose of nature (lines 14–18)

Oliver suggests that nature can help us feel less alone by reminding us that we belong to a larger world. She compares the world’s invitation to the repeated calls of wild geese. The calls make it seem as if nature is reaching out to us and reminding us of our place in the “family of things.”